HomeoClinic User Guide

Covers releases R0 + R1 + R2 (milestones M0 + M1 + M2): "Patient register".

This guide is cumulative. Each milestone's guide includes everything from the previous milestones plus the new features. This edition (R2) adds the patient register and instant search on top of the setup, lock and backup/restore features from R1. Later editions (R3, R4, ...) will add case taking, follow-ups, prescriptions, billing and the repertory.

HomeoClinic is a fully offline desktop application. It makes no network calls of its own: your patient data never leaves your computer, and everything in this guide works with the internet disconnected.

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1. Installing and opening the app (R0)

Ubuntu / Linux

You received one of these files:

- **`HomeoClinic_<version>_amd64.AppImage`** — portable, no installation. 1. Make it executable: right-click → Properties → Permissions → "Allow executing file as program", or in a terminal run `chmod +x HomeoClinic_*.AppImage`. 2. Double-click it (or run `./HomeoClinic_<version>_amd64.AppImage`).
- **`HomeoClinic_<version>_amd64.deb`** — installs into the system menu. 1. Install it: `sudo apt install ./HomeoClinic_<version>_amd64.deb`. 2. Launch "HomeoClinic" from your applications menu.

Windows

1. Run the **`.exe`** (NSIS) or **`.msi`** installer and follow the prompts. The app installs per-user; no administrator rights are required.
2. Launch "HomeoClinic" from the Start menu.

What you should see

- The application window opens within a few seconds.
- On a **brand-new installation**, the app opens the **first-run setup wizard** (see section 2).
- On an **already set-up installation**, the app opens the **lock screen** and asks for your PIN (see section 3).

The main application shell has:

- a **top bar** with a patient search box (press **F2** to focus it) and buttons for Help (**F1**) and Lock (**Ctrl+L**);
- a **left navigation** with Today, Patients, Backup and Settings (some items are disabled until later releases add their screens);
- a **status bar** at the bottom showing the save state, the last backup time, and the licence/trial state.

> In R2 the working areas are: the setup wizard, the lock screen, the Today screen, the **Patients** register and search (new in R2), and Backup. Case taking, prescriptions, billing and the repertory arrive in later releases.

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2. First-run setup wizard (R1)

The first time you open the app on a new computer, the setup wizard runs automatically. It has at most four short steps and should take only a couple of minutes. The language selector at the top is English for this release.

Step 1 — Doctor profile

Enter your professional details. These print on every prescription and receipt in later releases.

- **Full name** (required)
- **Qualification** (required) — e.g. BHMS, MD(Hom)
- **Registration number** and **Council** (required)
- **Phone** and **Email** (optional)
- **Signature image** and **Clinic logo** (optional)

Click **Next**. Required fields that are empty show an inline message under the field.

Step 2 — Clinic profile

- **Clinic name** (required)
- **Address** (required)
- **Default consultation fee** and **Default follow-up fee** (required) — amounts are shown in Indian number format
- **Phone**, **GSTIN**, **Timings** (optional)

Click **Next**.

Step 3 — Security (PIN and recovery code)

1. **Set a PIN** (4 to 6 digits) and **confirm** it. This PIN protects all your patient data.
2. Choose the **auto-lock** time (how many idle minutes before the app locks itself; default 15).
3. After the PIN is confirmed, the app shows a **one-time recovery code**. - **Write it down or click Print.** It is shown only once. - If you ever forget your PIN, this recovery code is the only way back into your data.
4. Tick **"I have saved my recovery code"** to continue.

> **Keep the recovery code safe and separate from the computer.** There is no way to recover your data without either the PIN or the recovery code — this is what keeps patient data private.

Step 4 — Licence

- Select **Start 30-day free trial**. This release uses a built-in **Development trial**; buying and importing a real licence arrives in a later release.

Click **Finish setup**. The app creates your encrypted database, starts the trial, and opens the **Today** screen, unlocked and ready.

> **Setup must be finished before anything else is available.** The rest of the app — including Patients and Backup — cannot be reached until you complete the wizard and start the trial here. **Finish setup** is the only way out of the wizard; there is no shortcut that skips the trial. (If you close the app mid-setup, it reopens on the wizard where you left off.)

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3. Locking and unlocking the app (R1)

Your data sits behind a single PIN entry.

When the app locks

- **On every launch** after setup is complete.
- **Automatically** after the idle time you chose (default 15 minutes).
- **On demand** — press **Ctrl+L** or click the **Lock** button in the top bar at any time.

Unlocking

1. Type your **PIN** and press **Enter** (or click **Unlock**).
2. A correct PIN unlocks immediately and returns you to where you were.
3. A wrong PIN shows an inline message and lets you try again — the app never locks you out or wipes anything for a wrong entry.

Forgot your PIN

1. On the lock screen, click **Forgot PIN?**.
2. Enter the **recovery code** from setup, then set and confirm a **new PIN**.
3. Click **Reset PIN**. You can now unlock with the new PIN.

> Unlocking and recovery happen entirely on your computer — no internet is used or required.

Trial status in the status bar (R1)

The status bar shows your licence state, e.g. **"Licence: Trial — expires (N days left)"**. The days-remaining counts down against a tamper-proof clock: setting the computer's date backwards does **not** extend the trial.

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4. Registering patients (R2, new)

Open **Patients** from the left navigation, then **New patient** (or press **F4**). This opens the registration form (screen S06).

The registration form

- **Name** (required).
- **Age or Date of birth** — enter one; age may be estimated.
- **Sex**, **Mobile**, **Alternate mobile**, **Address**, **City**, **Occupation**, **Marital status**, **Blood group**, **Referred by** — all optional.
- A **patient code** (e.g. `HC-000123`) is assigned automatically with your clinic prefix. Codes are **never reused**, even after a patient is deleted and restored.
- Required fields validate inline; fees and money show in Indian number format.

Patient photo (R2)

In the form you can attach a photo two ways:

- **Choose file** — pick an image file from disk.
- **Use webcam** — capture from the camera. The app asks for camera access; if a camera is unavailable or access is denied, it tells you and you can fall back to a file.

You can **remove**, **retake**, or **swap** the photo (file ↔ webcam) before or after saving — the photo updates with the patient record.

Duplicate warning

Before saving, if another patient matches on **name + mobile** or **name + date of birth** (including common Indian-name spelling variants), the form shows a **duplicate warning** listing the possible matches. It does not block you — you decide whether it's truly a new patient.

Click **Save**. The new patient is stored and becomes **findable immediately** in search.

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5. Finding patients — global search (R2, new)

Press **F2** or **Ctrl+K** (or click the top-bar search box) to open the global search overlay from any screen. It finds patients from the first character you type — no need to choose a field.

What it matches

- **Name** — any word prefix, e.g. typing `ram ku` finds "Ramesh Kumar".
- **Patient ID** — full code or just the digits, e.g. `123` finds `HC-000123`.
- **Mobile** — any 4 or more consecutive digits, ignoring `+91` and spaces.
- **City** and **family member name**.
- **Phonetic / spelling variants** of Indian names — e.g. `sarma` finds "Sharma", `laxmi` finds "Lakshmi", `mohd` finds "Mohammad". Exact matches always rank above phonetic ones.

Using it

- Results update as you type and each row shows photo, name, ID, age/sex, mobile, city, last visit and dues.
- Use **Up/Down** to move and **Enter** to open the patient's dashboard. **Enter** on an exact ID or mobile match opens that patient directly.
- When the box is empty, your **last 20 opened patients** are shown.
- Search stays fast — results appear in well under a tenth of a second even with tens of thousands of patients.

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6. The patient list and filters (R2, new)

Open **Patients** to see the full list with a filter panel (screen S05).

- **Filters available now:** last visit older than N days, next follow-up (today / overdue / date range), age range, sex, city, and "has dues". Filters combine together; results are sortable by name, ID, last visit and next follow-up.
- **Export CSV** writes the current filtered, sorted list to a file.
- Some filters (by remedy, diagnosis, potency, case-note text, tags, and saved filters) are shown but **disabled** — they switch on in later releases once case and prescription data exists.

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7. The patient dashboard (R2, new)

Clicking a patient (from search or the list) opens their dashboard (screen S07):

- **Demographics banner** — name, code, age/sex, mobile, city, referred by, photo — plus any **allergies / alerts**.
- **Family** — linked family members with quick-switch.
- **Visit timeline, last prescription and dues** appear here, but are **empty in R2** because case taking, prescriptions and billing arrive in later releases. The consultation quick-action buttons are hidden until then.

From the dashboard you can **Edit** the patient, **Export** their record (PDF or JSON), or move them to the **recycle bin**.

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8. Recycle bin — delete and restore (R2, new)

HomeoClinic never hard-deletes a patient by accident:

1. On the dashboard, choose **Move to recycle bin**; confirm by the patient's name. The patient leaves normal search and lists for **30 days**.
2. To bring them back, **restore** from the recycle bin — all their data returns and they are searchable again.
3. A **permanent delete** is possible from the recycle bin but **asks for your PIN** first, because it cannot be undone.

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9. Backing up your data (R1)

Backup becomes available **after** you finish the first-run setup (section 2). Once setup is complete, open **Backup** from the left navigation (or click the "Last backup" chip in the status bar).

Back up now (to a folder or USB drive)

1. Under **Back up now**, choose a destination with **Choose folder...** or **Use USB drive...**.
2. Enter a **backup password** (at least 8 characters). The first time, you also confirm it.
3. Optionally tick **Remember on this PC** so scheduled backups never ask for the password again on this computer.
4. Click **Back up now**.

The app writes a single encrypted file, `*.hcbak`, containing your database and attachments (now including your patients and their photos). After writing, it verifies the file (checksum + decrypt test).

> The backup password is **separate** from your app PIN. You need this password to restore the backup on another computer, so store it safely.

Automatic daily backups

- Automatic daily backup keeps the last **14 daily**, **8 weekly** and **12 monthly** copies, pruning older ones.
- It runs on app close or the first launch of the day and uses your remembered password, so it never interrupts you.

Backup health

- The screen and the status-bar chip show when the **last good backup** ran.
- If the last successful backup is **more than 7 days old**, a warning banner appears prompting you to back up.

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10. Restoring from a backup (R1)

Use this to recover data, or to move to a new computer (install HomeoClinic on the new PC, then restore).

1. On the **Backup** screen, under **Restore from a backup**, click **Choose backup file (.hcbak)...**.
2. **Step 1 — File and password:** select the `.hcbak` file and enter its backup password. A wrong password is refused here and the wizard does not continue.
3. **Step 2 — Preview:** the app shows what the backup contains (counts and dates) **without changing anything yet**.
4. **Step 3 — Confirm:** click **Restore**. Before replacing anything, the app takes a **safety copy of your current data**, then swaps in the restored data. A mistaken restore is therefore recoverable.

After restore, your doctor and clinic profile and **all patients** (with their photos) come back.

> Upgrading from an older version keeps your data: installing a new release over an existing one migrates your database automatically and your previous backups still open.
>
> Backup and restore perform **no network calls** and work fully offline.

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11. Quick reference — keyboard shortcuts (R0–R2)

Key	Action
F1	Help
F2 / Ctrl+K	Focus / open global patient search
F3	Today
F4	New patient
Ctrl+L	Lock the app now
Up / Down	Move through search results / lists
Enter	Open the selected patient / confirm the current step / unlock
Esc	Close a dialog or the search overlay (never discards data)

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12. Privacy and safety notes (R1/R2)

- **Offline only.** HomeoClinic makes no network connections of its own and opens no listening ports.
- **Encrypted at rest.** Your database and patient photos are encrypted; the key is derived from your PIN.
- **No data in logs.** Diagnostic logs never contain patient details.
- **Never lost by accident.** Patients are soft-deleted to a 30-day recycle bin; permanent deletion asks for your PIN.
- **Your data is always recoverable** with your PIN or your recovery code, and always **exportable** (per-patient PDF/JSON, filtered-list CSV, or a full encrypted backup).

Appendix — what is NOT in this release

The following arrive in later milestones and are intentionally absent or disabled in R2: case taking and follow-up visits, prescriptions and printing, billing and reports, the repertory and Materia Medica, buying/importing a real licence, full-text case-note search, the by-remedy/diagnosis/potency filters, saved filters, patient tags, per-patient attachments beyond the photo, and the guided "move to a new computer" flow. When those ship, this guide will be extended to cover them.

HomeoClinic User Guide — R2 edition (M0 + M1 + M2). Generated from `documents/user-guide/HomeoClinic-User-Guide-R2.md`.